rainfall totals of 15 to 30 inches (380 to 760 mm), along with high evaporation rates, often are insufficient for growing crops during the summer; supplemental irrigation is necessary.

32. About one-third of North America, including the high Arctic latitudes, has a dry climate. Chief dry areas lie in the American Southwest, where a combination of the midlatitude high-pressure belt, the tropical continental air mass, and rain shadow effects behind the high Sierra Nevada has led to lack of rainfall. Summer winds blow from the continent outward, discounting the effect of Pacific subtropical air.
33. One of the greatest sweeps of forest in the world, the boreal forest (or taiga) extends in a vast and virtually unbroken sheet of green eastward from the Aleutian Islands through Alaska and northern Canada to the island of Newfoundland. Its conifers are much shorter than those of the Pacific Coast but grow in denser, sometimes almost impenetrable, stands. The boreal forest essentially is the domain of spruce and balsam fir, with various species of pine becoming significant in the west and jack pine and tamarack in the east; interspersed among the conifers are such deciduous species as white birch and aspen
34. The Laurentian mixed forest occurs in the Great Lakes-St. Lawrence, the upper Mississippi-Ohio, and the New England lowland regions.
35. The Eastern Upland forest: Also known as the Acadian forest in Canada, the Eastern Upland forest covers much of the central and northern Appalachians and New England; there, polar continental air is pronounced, while elevation modifies the tropical maritime winds. The growing season ranges from 90 to 120 days, and winter cold brings subzero temperatures.
36.